RSS Digest
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1. Inline rendering with document?.currentScript
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-17T21:11:12+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/17/document-currentscript/
Inline rendering with document?.currentScript Lean Rada describes a neat trick that takes advantage of the document.currentScript property. You can use that to drop in a tiny inline element that replaces itself when the page loads: The year is document.currentScript.replaceWith(new Date().getFullYear()) If you define a shortcut function like this: $=(...n)=>document.currentScript.replaceWith(...n) You get a tiny template language: The year is $(new Date().getFullYear()) Tags: javascript

2. web-edit 0.1a2
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-17T13:16:49+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/17/web-edit/
Release: web-edit 0.1a2 web-edit (previously) is my tiny web app for browsing and editing files in a folder. I mainly built it for editing files on different machines via Tailscale. I added a "copy to clipboard" option for both text and image data. I needed this because I was running pelican prompts on a laptop from my phone (here’s DeepSeek 4.1 Flash 1017) and I wanted an easy way to copy the resulting logs into a Gist. Tags: projects , pelican-riding-a-bicycle , deepseek

3. Writing is no longer proof of work
Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Sun, 18 Oct 2026 00:00:00 GMT
Link: https://seangoedecke.com/writing-is-no-longer-proof-of-work/
Tech companies structurally depend on writing to serve as evidence, in the same way that Bitcoin depends on proof-of-work hashing. However, in the last few years, LLMs have started to undermine this practice. How can writing be like proof-of-work? When I?m writing something at work, it?s not always to communicate an idea. Sometimes it?s because having a piece of writing is useful as evidence : of compliance with some process, of the fact that I put in effort, or of the fact that I know about some topic. Here are some examples. Writing as evidence of compliance The most obvious instance of writing as evidence is filling out mandatory templates: ?risk assessments?, ?impact evaluations?, and so on. The purpose of these is rarely to assess risk or evaluate impact. It?s some combination of: Employees wanting to demonstrate that they?re taking some incident seriously by introducing new process A legal requirement that companies have developed the least-expensive way to technically satisfy Internal company rules intending to scare lazy or uncommitted engineers away from making dangerous changes Smaller companies trying to role-play processes from larger companies that are doing one of th...

4. Cloud of suspicion lifted from NIST curves
Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sat, 17 Oct 2026 15:39:06 +0000
Link: https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/10/17/nist-curves-exonorated/
NIST published a set of elliptic curves for cryptography in 2000. The seeds for the curves were supplied by the NSA, and cryptographers suspected the agency may have installed backdoors in the curves. And not without reason: the NSA did insert a backdoor in the Dual_EC_DRBG random number generator. Two days ago researchers at Anthropic [?] The post Cloud of suspicion lifted from NIST curves first appeared on John D. Cook .

5. Book Review: Are You *Really* The Doctor? by Matthew Hutchinson ?????
Source: Terence Eden?s Blog | Published: Sat, 17 Oct 2026 11:34:57 +0000
Link: https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/10/book-review-are-you-really-the-doctor-by-matthew-hutchinson/
A few months ago, I went to see Dr Hutchinson record his stand-up comedy special for the BBC - it’s about his experiences working in the NHS as a Black doctor. As the title of the book

implies, some of the public can be a mite suspicious that anyone with even a hint of melanin can rise beyond being a porter or, at a push, a nurse. Much like Adam Kay’s "This Is Going To Hurt", this is part?

6. This Week in Package Management: 17 October 2026
Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-10-17T10:00:00+00:00
Link: https://nesbitt.io/2026/10/17/this-week-in-package-management.html
This week?s package management news, gathered from the package manager OPML feed collection , my posts and boosts on Mastodon , and anything people sent me. Releases pnpm 12.12 to 12.14 add a remoteCache setting that shares signed task results and dependency builds through a pnpr server or any server that implements the Turborepo Remote Cache API, and 12.14 adds sideEffectsCache.exclude for packages whose builds depend on system libraries outside the cache key. 12.13 adds pnpm profile and pnpm token , plus a storeIndexFormat: files setting that replaces the SQLite store index with one file per package for stores shared over a network filesystem. mise 2026.10.8 to 2026.10.12 reads release lists, tags and attestations from its mise-versions host instead of api.github.com . A cold mise install of github: tools now makes no GitHub API requests, and mise ls-remote python went from 961 ms to 93 ms. 2026.10.9 fixes a trust bypass where an untrusted path: tool version could put a directory on PATH , and 2026.10.11 fixes a trust issue in remote task files. vlt 1.4.0 turns the global store on by default on macOS, cloning packages with copy-on-write clonefile through node:ffi on Node 26.1 an...

7. Reading List 10/17/26
Source: Construction Physics | Published: Sat, 17 Oct 2026 12:03:37 GMT
Link: https://www.construction-physics.com/p/reading-list-101726
Icon?s fundraising, employment in China?s solar industry, grid-scale battery reliability, Tesla?s flying roadster, and more.

8. Pluralistic: Israeli ad-tech company was a delivery system for "mercenary spyware" (17 Oct 2026)
Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Sat, 17 Oct 2026 10:47:35 +0000
Link: https://pluralistic.net/2026/10/17/mercenary-spyware/
Today’s links Israeli ad-tech company was a delivery system for "mercenary spyware": And they used Google, Facebook and every other major ad platform to do it. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Big Mouth Billy Bass x Linux; No-Fly lists v common sense; Lemony Snicket advises the 1%; "Aloha From Hell"; KSR v Elon Musk; "Everything Belongs to the Future"; Trump’s mail-servers run Win2003; Copyfraud v covid. Upcoming appearances: Vancouver, Victoria, Ottawa, Vienna, Kilkenny, Oxford, Sheffield, Virtual, Oxford, Montreal. Recent appearances: Where I’ve been. Latest books: You keep readin’ em, I’ll keep writin’ ’em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I’ll keep writin’ ’em. Colophon: All the rest. Israeli ad-tech company was a delivery system for "mercenary spyware" (permalink) More than half of all internet users have installed an ad-blocker; Doc Searls calls it the largest consumer boycott in history. As large as that boycott is, everyone ? yes, everyone ? should block every "programmatic" ad, because the entire system is so insecure that failing to do so could result in the total compromise of any or all of your digital devices. That’s the inescapable conclusion o...

9. Notes on the complex roots of unity
Source: Eli Bendersky’s website | Published: 2026-10-17T18:18:00-07:00
Link: https://eli.thegreenplace.net/2026/notes-on-the-complex-roots-of-unity/
One of the most wonderful aspects of math is how deep we can get by studying seemingly trivial questions. Consider the roots of unity, where "unity" simply means the number 1. Basics: roots of unity for real numbers Studying the roots of unity usually begins in middle school: what is ?

10. How the AI boom might really end: 5 scenarios
Source: Martin Alderson | Published: Sun, 18 Oct 2026 00:00:00 GMT
Link: https://martinalderson.com/posts/how-the-ai-boom-might-really-end/?utm_source=rss&utm_medium=rss&utm_campaign=feed
With chip stocks on their longest losing streak since 2008 and Anthropic heading for IPO, five ways the AI boom could end - and why I think the value is real but may not flow to the people putting the money in.